



LESSON FIVE

# DOM BASICS THE TRIGGER

The depth of market: bids, asks, aggressive against passive, and delta. The tool that turns every level in this series into an actual entry.

By Sires

Ether, the free side of Ethos

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This guide pairs with the video. [Watch it](#) for the live walkthrough, keep this next to the charts.



# What the DOM actually is

Everything so far has been context: the auction, the profiles, the volatility. This is where the method gets its trigger. The DOM, the depth of market, shows you the live orders at every price.

The market only moves for one reason: **buyers and sellers**. The DOM is where you watch them do it.

BIDS, THE LEFT SIDE

The list of buy limit orders below price. Buyers waiting to be filled, the liquidity underneath the market.

ASKS, THE RIGHT SIDE

The list of sell limit orders above price. Sellers waiting to be filled, the liquidity overhead.

DOM:EPZ25 × +

EPZ25 ▼ 1 ⬆️⬆️ ≡ 🔄 ▼ L+S ▼ 🔌 💡 🔄 ⚙️ ➡️➡️

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| Volume | Price   | Note | Bid | Bid | @Bi | @As | Ask | Ask | Order | + |
|--------|---------|------|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-------|---|
| 6412   | 6664.50 |      |     |     |     |     | 68  |     |       |   |
| 6761   | 6664.25 |      |     |     |     |     | 67  |     |       |   |
| 8399   | 6664.00 |      |     |     |     |     | 86  |     |       |   |
| 8255   | 6663.75 |      |     |     |     |     | 57  |     |       |   |
| 10271  | 6663.50 |      |     |     |     |     | 77  |     |       |   |
| 9512   | 6663.25 |      |     |     |     |     | 61  |     |       |   |
| 8038   | 6663.00 |      |     |     |     |     | 82  |     |       |   |
| 8643   | 6662.75 |      |     |     |     |     | 82  |     |       |   |
| 8193   | 6662.50 |      |     |     |     |     | 87  |     |       |   |
| 8241   | 6662.25 |      |     |     |     |     | 110 |     |       |   |
| 11306  | 6662.00 |      |     |     |     |     | 114 |     |       |   |
| 10472  | 6661.75 |      |     |     |     |     | 92  | 1   |       |   |
| 11438  | 6661.50 |      |     |     |     |     | 106 | -1  |       |   |
| 14218  | 6661.25 |      |     |     |     |     | 84  | -3  |       |   |
| 13910  | 6661.00 |      |     |     |     |     | 130 | -6  |       |   |
| 15325  | 6660.75 |      |     |     |     |     | 111 | -7  |       |   |
| 13342  | 6660.50 |      |     |     |     |     | 112 | 12  |       |   |
| 8924   | 6660.25 |      |     |     |     |     | 98  | -20 |       |   |
| 9990   | 6660.00 |      |     |     |     |     | 76  | -20 |       |   |
| 7272   | 6659.75 |      |     |     |     | 3   | 41  | -53 |       |   |
| 8022   | 6659.50 |      | 19  | 42  | 25  | 28  |     |     |       |   |
| 5942   | 6659.25 |      | 38  | 73  | 42  | 164 |     |     |       |   |
| 7081   | 6659.00 |      | 51  | 63  | 13  | 136 |     |     |       |   |
| 6049   | 6658.75 |      | 87  | 88  | 11  | 95  |     |     |       |   |

# Aggressive vs passive

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Every participant on the ladder is one of two kinds, and the whole game is watching how they interact.

## AGGRESSIVE, MARKET ORDERS

They cross the spread and hit the ask or the bid because they want the fill immediately. Best ask 5000.25, best bid 5000.00, an aggressive buyer clicks buy market and instantly pays 5000.25, they are lifting the offer. Aggression is urgency and conviction, this is what actually moves price.

## PASSIVE, LIMIT ORDERS

They place a bid or an offer and wait. A passive buyer rests a limit at 4999.75 and waits for sellers to come to him. Passive because they never chase, they provide the liquidity the aggressive side consumes.

## THE INTERACTION IS THE MARKET

Price moves when aggression eats through passivity. Every level that holds or breaks, every wick, every trend leg is that one contest, repeated.



# Delta, the running score

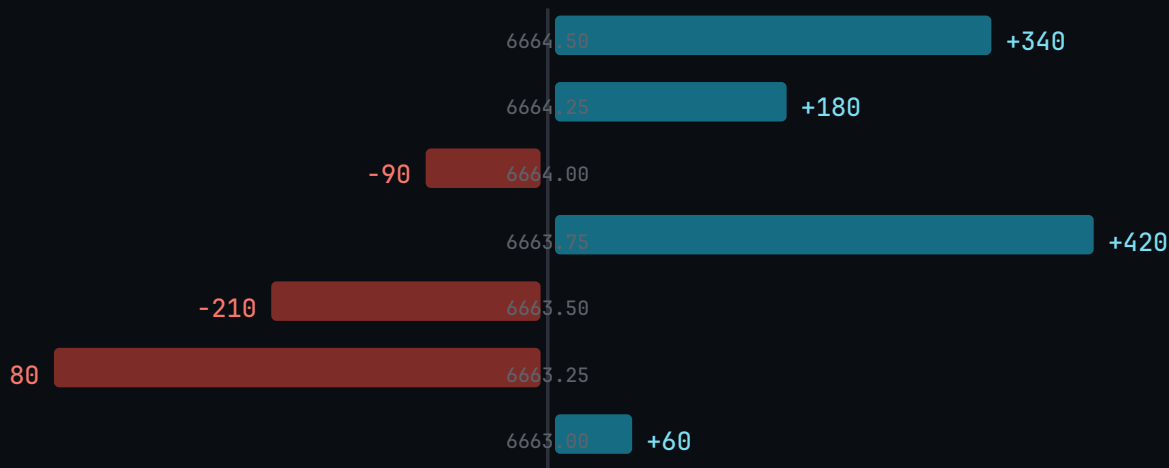
Delta is the running score of that contest. It is the net volume of market buys minus market sells at each price level.

## POSITIVE DELTA

More aggressive buyers than sellers. The buying is real, market orders are lifting offers and pushing price up.

## NEGATIVE DELTA

More aggressive sellers than buyers. Market orders are hitting bids, pressure is pushing price down.



Delta alongside the ladder: net market buying against market selling per price, the aggression made visible. Green is net buying, red is net selling.

## THE READ THAT MATTERS

Delta against price is the tell. Heavy positive delta while price goes nowhere means someone is absorbing the buying, and that argument is the next lesson.



# Speed of tape and the spread

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Two things on the ladder that beginners never look at, and both change the read completely: the speed of the tape, and the width of the spread.

## SPEED OF TAPE

How fast the time and sales prints scroll. A tape that suddenly rips at a level is urgency arriving. A tape that freezes at a level is hesitation, or a big passive order soaking everything up. The footprint is the history, the speed is the pulse.

## THE SPREAD

The gap between best bid and best ask. It stays one tick when liquidity is deep and healthy. It widens the instant liquidity thins out, which is your earliest warning that a level is about to break or a fast move is coming.

## FAST TAPE INTO A LEVEL

Aggression is committed. If the level still holds, that is absorption worth trading. If it breaks, the speed carries the continuation.

## SPREAD WIDENS

Liquidity is pulling. Do not lean on the level, and do not chase into the gap, the fills get ugly and the stops get run.

## THE FULL PICTURE

Depth tells you what is resting, delta tells you who is aggressive, speed tells you how urgent, and the spread tells you how healthy. Read all four and the ladder stops being numbers and starts being a conversation.



# The ladder as your trigger

The DOM is the trigger layer of the whole method. The profiles give you the level, the ladder tells you whether the level is actually being defended.



## **Bring a level to the ladder**

Never watch the DOM in a vacuum. Come to it with the shelf, the ledge or the value edge already marked.



## **Watch who is aggressive at the level**

Are market orders attacking it or drying up? Urgency arriving at your level is the start of a trade.



## **Watch what the passive side does**

Does resting size hold, reload and stack, or does it pull? Liquidity behaviour is the defence being shown or abandoned.



## **Score it with delta**

Aggression with movement is continuation. Aggression without movement is absorption, somebody big is on the other side.



## **Then execute, small and precise**

The DOM gives tight entries with tiny stops. That precision is the whole reason this method ends at the ladder.

### **WHAT COMES NEXT**

Lesson 6 covers absorption and stacking, the two ladder behaviours that make entries. Lesson 7 covers icebergs and spoofing, the tricks the big players use to hide.





# Now watch the ladder.

You now know who moves the market and how to see them doing it.  
Inside Ethos, the mentorship, the KG models put the ladder to work live,  
three sessions a week.



## **Levels first, ladder second**

The DOM confirms locations you already marked, it never invents them.



## **Aggression versus liquidity**

Who is urgent, who is defending. That contest is every trade.



## **Delta keeps the score**

Aggression without movement is the biggest tell on the ladder.

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